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The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2021

Round 2



Solution and marking.

Scoring: (max 20)

- **1.1.** 1 point for each correct number (max 16)
- **1.2.** 1 point for each correct number (max 4)

Q1.1.

	A	B	C	D
words	yêkā rakwa	kapwa tâmurṣita	Indra sēdēṅ amwit	kinon hyaṅ
position (1-4)	1	4	3	2
words	daśagunan	tan sora	pwa tēkap nikā	rūpanya dentānaku
position (1-4)	3	1	2	4
words	widyādarī mūr tēhēr	sinambahakēṅ iṅ	liṅ hyaṅ	Śakra nahan
position (1-4)	4	3	1	2
words	lokika	tan sangkēṅ	lwir sangrahēṅ	wiṣaya prayojñananira
position (1-4)	4	1	3	2

Q1.2.

word	#1-19
paramārthapandita	4
ametmetâśrayā	11
santosâhēlētān	1
candanâpāyunan	14

Commentary

The pattern of the śārdūlawikrīdita is as follows (H, L = Heavy, Light):

HHHLL HLHLL LHHHL HHLH/L

- Any syllable featuring either a vowel with a macron mark or â, ê, e or o as the core vowel is heavy.
- Any syllable featuring a vowel followed by two successive consonants (even in the succeeding word) is also heavy.
- All other syllables are light.

Source: <https://library.oapen.org/handle/20.500.12657/34659>

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Solution and marking.

Scoring: (max 51)

- 2.1: (max 36)
 - 1 point for each correct language (H or D). (max 12)
 - 2 points for each correct translation (A-F). (max 24)
- 2.2: 3 points for each correct English sentence. (max 15)
 - 2 points with one error (one wrong word or wrong syntactic role assignment)
 - 1 point with two such errors.
 - Accept
 - *will Verb for Verb.*
 - *him/he/his for her/she*
 - *father for the father* – but not *the father for her father*
 - *end for edge*
 - *come down for descends*

Q2.1.

#	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
H/D	D	H	D	D	H	H	D	D	H	H	H	D
A-F	F	D	B	E	A	F	D	A	E	C	B	C

Q2.2.

Hawu or Dhao	English
Ra pa'èra ama	They strengthened the father. or: They made the father strong.
Ki pedutu roo ri ama no, pedute noo ri roo	If her father follows (them), they (will) follow (her).
Pebèlu roo ri noo	She made them forget.
Ladhe na puru, na nèdhi sebhe	If she descends, she sees the edge.
B'ole bèj'i	Don't sleep/lie down/be asleep.

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Commentary

First, let's learn a little more about Hawu and Dhao history and culture. It's nice to get some broader context, and it also shows respect for the people who speak and who have historically spoken the languages presented in this problem.

Today the majority of Hawu people practise Protestant Christianity, but until the 1970s most of the Hawu people maintained their ancestral religion, Jingi Tiu, and traditional ways of life. In pre-colonial times, the Hawu people maintained six religio-political domains on the island of Hawu (Savu), including the domain of Seba (after which the modern-day Seba, mentioned in the problem, is named). Each domain had a Council of Priests (of Jingi Tiu). These domains were reorganized during and after the colonial era until a 2001 autonomy law, which the East Nusa Tenggara province used to create new districts that largely reflected the structure of the ancient domains. The Hawu people traditionally transmitted their knowledge orally in a number of ways, for example by naming places in remembrance of key events in Hawu history and naming people by the roles they played in society. The Hawu remember long genealogies over tens of generations that have links at certain stages to the various parts of Hawu island. They recognize two matrilineal lines descended from two sisters as well as patrilineal descent groups and lineages. These genealogies structure Hawu society and are recited during ritual performances; for example, at funerals the reciting of the departed's genealogy memorializes the connection of the departed to his or her ancestors.

Source: Duggan, G. (2009). The Genealogical Model of Savu, Eastern Indonesia. *Journal of Indonesian Social Sciences and Humanities*, 2, 163–177. LIPI / KITLV Press.

<https://web.archive.org/web/20120302193735/http://www.kitlv-journals.nl/index.php/ijslh/article/viewFile/URN:NBN:NL:UI:10-1-100162/8444>

The Dhao people say their language and culture is similar to that of Hawu island. They recount that the first settlers of their island were three people named Rika, Jote, and Pesa Kèli. Pesa Kèli came from the island of Hawu and brought the indigo plant, dhao, from which Dhao (Ndao) island and the Dhao people get their names. (The Hawu also tell a version of this history.) Traditionally, many Dhao men practiced gold- and silversmithing, traveling around the region to sell their creations. Today, most Dhao men have shifted away from smithing to fishing and local business activities. Women traditionally wove fabrics dyed with a technique known as ikat and are still productive in ikat weaving today. They leave their homes to sell their products, to seek orders for new weavings, or to collect debts from their customers. Thousands of jewels and ikats are produced each year and are traded with neighboring islands. The men tend to leave the island during the dry season to sell jewelry and other products of smithing and the ikat weaving products made by the women. In contrast to the Hawu, the Dhao trace their descent only patrilineally.

Source: Balukh, J. I. (2020). *A grammar of Dhao: An endangered Austronesian language in Eastern Indonesia*. <https://scholarlypublications.universiteitleiden.nl/access/item%3A2967898/view>

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Solution to the problem

Sound correspondences (identified using the table at the beginning):

Hawu	Dhao
a	a
n	n
t	t
e	a
l	l
o	o/u
r	r
b	bh
è	è
j'	j'
i	i (but e in dedha)
b'	b
h	s
d	dh
d'	d
u	u
p	p (but bh in subha , m in madhutu)

Using the differences between Hawu and Dhao shown in the above table, we can figure out which sentences in (1-12) are in Hawu and which are in Dhao. For example, **s** is a sound unique to Dhao, so any sentence with an **s** will be in Dhao. Then we can match the six sentences in Hawu and the six sentences in Dhao to their translations and analyze the grammar.

Hawu grammar (simplified for this problem)

Dhao grammar (simplified for this problem)

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word order: either Verb (Object) Subject (Prepositional Phrase) or V S (O) (PP) - in this problem, pronoun objects were only used in VOS order tense/aspect/mood: ta V = non-past tense; otherwise the default interpretation is past tense ke in this problem always appears immediately following ta V - V ... teruu = <i>keep Ving, continue to V</i> b'ole V = <i>don't V</i> verbs: - verbs have specific forms that agree with the absolutive-marked noun phrase in number pebèlo = absolutive NP is singular; pebèlu = absolutive NP is plural pedute/pedutu nèru/nèru pe-V = <i>to cause to V</i> (so we call pe- a <i>causative prefix</i>) - this changes an intransitive verb to a transitive verb - so hewina = <i>remember</i>, pehewina = <i>remind</i> (not in UKLO problem) Note: In the problem, pebèlo/pebèlu was translated as <i>make to forget</i>, but in actual Hawu usage, this verb means something more like <i>forget on purpose</i>. pronouns:	word order: S V (O) (PP) only tense/aspect/mood: - no visible tense-marking - V ... taruu = <i>keep Ving, continue to V</i> baku V = <i>don't V</i> verbs: pa-V = <i>to cause to V</i> - another example: puru = <i>descend</i>, papuru = <i>lower (something)</i> èra = <i>(to be) strong</i>, pa'èra = <i>strengthen</i> pronouns:
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- **noo** = 3SG, *she* (or *he*) → **no** = *her* (or *his*)
- **roo** = 3PL, *they* → **ro** = *their*

Noun Phrases:

- **ne** marks the object of a transitive verb and the subject of an intransitive verb (this is called *absolutive case*), as well as the predicate of a copular construction (e.g. in **D'ai-tèra noo ne rui** 'She really is a strong one.')
- **ne** cannot be used with pronouns, unlike **ri**
- **ri** marks the subject of a transitive verb (this is called *ergative case*)
- if there is a possessor, the order is Possessed Possessor
 - so **ngidi dahi**, lit. *edge sea* = *the edge of the sea*

Prepositional Phrases:

- the order is Preposition NounPhrase

Adverbs:

- **d'ai-tèra** goes to the left of what it modifies

- **na** = 3SG, *she* (or *he*), *her* (or *his*)
- **ra** = 3PL, *they*, *their*

Noun Phrases:

- no visible case-marking
- if there is a possessor, the order is Possessed Possessor
 - so **kètu na**, lit. *head 3SG* = *her head*

Prepositional Phrases:

- the order is Preposition NounPhrase

Adverbs:

- **titu-kèna** goes to the right of what it modifies

Note: in Dhao, the word meaning *if* is **ladhe**, the same as the word **ladhe**, which also means *see*. This illustrates the process known as *syntactic change*. The word **ladhe** was probably originally just a verb, but speakers reinterpreted it to also mean *if* and to serve a different grammatical function.

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Solution and marking.

Scoring: (max 73)

3.1. (max 39)

- 1-4: 2 points for each completely correct English translation. (max 12)
 - 1 point with one wrong or missing word.
 - Allow two answers for 3 and 4, so 6 translations are possible.
 - Accept
 - *give a lot* or similar for *donate*
 - *look at* for *see*
 - *hear for* *listen to*
 - 1 point for #1: *You (sg) have seen/looked/watched*, without an object pronoun
- 5-10: (max 27)
 - 1 point for each morpheme (underlined and separated by +)
 - 1 point for each other completely correct Ainu word except *wa*.

3.2. Assign marks as shown in the commentary (max 34)

	Ainu	English
1	e nukarepa wa isam	You (sg) have shown/showed them.
2	ci yaynukarpa wa oka	We were seeing/looking at ourselves.
3	e koreruy wa an	He was donating you (sg). OR: They were donating you (sg). OR: You (sg) were donating (him).
4	nuruypa wa isam	He has listened (to him/them) a lot. OR: They have listened (to him/them) a lot.
5	eci <u>nu+pa</u> wa oka [4]	He was listening to you (pl).
6	e <u>yay+nu+ruy</u> wa an [5]	You (sg) were thinking a lot.
7	ci <u>kore+tek+re</u> wa an [5]	We were borrowing him.
8	<u>ipe+pa</u> as wa isam [4]	We have eaten.
9	<u>inkar+ruy+pa</u> wa oka [4]	They were staring.
10	an <u>nukar+tek+pa</u> wa isam [5]	I have glanced at them.

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Commentary

- **Syntax: (max 4)**
 - Every sentence ends with an 'aspect' marker (see below) following the word *wa*. **[1]**
 - Background: Subjects and objects are 'arguments' of the verb. Grammarians classify verbs by their transitivity as 'intransitive' (with one argument, e.g. *snore*) or 'transitive' verbs (with two arguments, e.g. *kick*). The two arguments of a transitive verb can be distinguished as 'agent' (A) and 'patient' (P), as in *She kicked it*, where she is the agent and it is the patient.
 - Transitivity affects word order in Ainu, as follows (Key: P = pronoun, V = verb, A = aspect particle)
 - Default: P V *wa* A **[2]**
 - Intransitive first person (I or we): V P *wa* A **[1]**
 - Background: Languages are classified according to how they treat the subject of an intransitive verb (S), and the agent (A) and patient (P) of a transitive verb. In a nominative-accusative language like English, S and A have similar treatment (e.g. *she*, not *her*) in contrast with P, while an ergative-absolutive language aligns S with P as 'absolutive', in contrast with A, called 'ergative' (Greek for 'working', as in *en-ergy*). In these terms, Ainu is partly nominative-accusative and partly ergative-absolutive, so we need both kinds of terminology: subject/object, and ergative/absolutive.
- **Pronouns: (max 9)**
 - Pronouns have three forms: **[2]**
 - for an intransitive subject
 - for a transitive subject
 - for a transitive object.
 - When two pronouns belong to the same verb, they fuse into a single word; for example, if the subject is 'you(pl)' and the object is 'me', *eci-* combines with *-en* to give *ecien*. **[2]**
 - The three forms are given in the following table.

Person	intransitive subject	transitive subject	object	points
1 sg	an	an-	-en	[1]
2 sg	e	e-	-e	[1]
3 sg	[zero]	[zero]	[zero]	[1]
1 pl	as	ci-	-un	[1]
2 pl	eci	eci-	-eci	[1]
3 pl	[zero]	[zero]	[zero]	

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- **Verbs: (max 16)**

- Each verb has two different roots depending on its transitivity: [2]
- The verbs are shown in the following table. [2; 1 for just one example]

Translation	Intransitive root	Transitive root
to eat	ipe	e
to see	inkar	nukar
to listen	inu	nu
to have/give	kor	kore**

** For this problem, **kore** *give* can be taken as a separate root from **kor** *have*, though it is actually the causative of **kor** (*give* = *cause someone to have*).

- There are also several stem-modifying affixes: (max 10)
 - **yay-** [1]: reflexive marker [1]
 - (note that in Ainu, *listening to oneself* = *thinking*) [1]
 - **-(r)e** [1]: causative marker (*eat* → *make someone eat* = *feed*, *see* → *make someone see* = *show*, *listen* = *make someone listen* → *tell*). [1]
 - If the verb root ends in **-r**, the suffix becomes **-e**. [1]
 - **-ruy** [1]: verb intensifier (can be translated by *a lot*, but it also bears a semantic role modifying the verb (*eat* → *devour*, *see* → *stare* etc.) [1]
 - **-tek** [1]: verb diminisher (the opposite of **-ruy** – *eat* → *taste*, *see* → *glance* etc.) [1]
- **-pa** is added if the absolutive is plural. [2]
- **Aspect: (max 5)**
 - Past perfect (*has/have Ved*) [1]: – **wa isam** [1]
 - Past continuous (*was/were Ving*): [1]
 - **wa an** if the absolutive is singular [1]
 - **wa oka** if it is plural. [1]

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Solution and marking.

Scoring: (max 39)

- **Q.4.1.** 1 point for each correct number. (max 19)
- **Q.4.2.** 1 point for each correct word. (max 9)
- **Q.4.3.** Assign points as indicated in the explanation (max 20)

Q.4.1.

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S
6	15	9	5	2	10	3	4	12	1	16	13	8	18	14	19	11	17	7

Q.4.2.

Hmong	English
lub hnuv	the sun
txoj hlua	the rope
zaj nkauj	the song
sau ntawv	the essay
daim teb	the field
lub txiv hmab	the grape

Q.4.3.

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Commentary

Each of the Hmong phrases is composed of two parts: a classifier followed by a noun. [2]

The classifiers in the problem are as follows: (max 14)

daim [1]	flat things [1]
kua [1]	liquids [1]
lub [1]	round things / general [1]
phau [1]	piles, stacks [1]
tsab [1]	letters, written things [1]
txoj [1]	long things [1]
zaj [1]	spoken [1]

Some nouns refer to only one thing (at least in the problem) e.g. **kev** means only road. Others, such as **mis** represent a broader concept, taking on different meanings depending on the classifier. [2]

Nouns can be combined to give compound nouns, where the first noun is the head/the word modified/the main word; the resulting compound then combines with an appropriate classifier. [2]

Here is a list of the pairings of Hmong and English phrases.

Hmong	English
daim nplooj	<i>the leaf</i>
daim ntawv	<i>the sheet of paper</i>
kua mis	<i>the milk</i>
kua txiv hmab	<i>the grape juice</i>
lub mis	<i>the breast</i>
lub ntaws	<i>the navel</i>
lub nyiaj	<i>the coin</i>
lub txiv	<i>the fruit</i>
phau khaub	<i>the pile of clothes</i>
phau ntawv	<i>the book</i>
phau nyiaj	<i>the stack of bank notes</i>
tsab ntawv	<i>the postal letter</i>
tsab xov	<i>the message (written)</i>
txoj hmab	<i>the vine</i>
txoj kev	<i>the road</i>
txoj kev thaj yeeb	<i>the way of peace</i>
txoj leeg	<i>the nerves</i>

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txoj ntaws	<i>the umbilical cord</i>
zaj xov	<i>the message (spoken)</i>

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Solution and marking.

Scoring: (max 51)

- Q5.1. (max 28)
 - A-D: 1 for each correct item separated by +. (max 10)
 - #A: accept *sit* for *sit down*
 - #A: accept *you(pl) your snake*
 - #B: accept *stand up* for *stand* – but not *are standing*
 - #B: accept *you(sg) ... you will...*
 - #C: accept *baby* for *child*.
 - #D: accept *down* for *to* – but not *will go* for *are going*
 - E-H: 1 for each completely correct word. No half marks. (max 18)
 - ignore hyphens in the solution below.
 - insist on correct order of words
- Q5.2. Assign marks as shown in the explanation (max 23)
 - Any solution which includes the correct information should be given marks, regardless of organisation.

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	Tawala	English
A	Apo onaduhuna babana motami igobu	You (pl) will sit down + because + your (pl) snake is dirty.
B	Inapa unatowolo apo unamae	If + you (sg) stand, + you (sg) will stay/be staying.
C	Tewela hidewadewa ma natum dewadewana	The children are (being) good + but + your (sg) child is (always) (being) good.
D	Unenae nu tahaya daodaona	You (sg) are going to the long path.
E	Ginouli bigabiga-na o-danena-ya	You (pl) steal a swampy thing.
F	Inapa tahaya i-na-dao apo u-na-gobu	If the path is long, you (sg) will be dirty.
G	Limi natu-na meme-na i-hilage ma ega hilhilage-na.	Limi's settled child is dying but is not dead.
H	Tewela daladala-hi ano-hi	The crawling children have substance.

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Commentary

How to solve it.

Most of the problem is fairly routine (e.g. the syntax and affixes). The main difficulty is the reduplication (doubling), which affects both verbs and equivalents of English adjectives, which we can treat as verbs in Tawala. However, the key is to draw up a table of how the reduplicated forms of verbs behave. At the foot of this explanation is an example of such a table showing all the verbs in the data classified according to whether they are reduplicated or not, and whether they have prefixes for the subject.

Explanation and mark scheme

Nouns. 4 marks

- Nouns are not marked for number. [1]
- They can be marked for possessor with a suffix: [1]

2s	-m
3s	-na
2p	-mi
3p	-hi [1 if all correct]

- Note that **natu** means *son/daughter*, so is always possessed; **tewela** means *child* more generally, so is not possessed. [1]

Verbs. 10 marks

- All verbs fall into one of two [in reality more] categories:
 - “active”, which here all have a sense of motion or activity: **towolo** *stand*, **dala** *crawl*, **danene** *steal*, **duhuna** *sit*, **nae** *go* [1 for idea, 2 for semantic difference OR list]
 - and “stative”, which describe a state: **hilage** *be dying*, **gobu** *be dirty*, **dao** *be long*, **mae** *be staying*, **dewadewa** *be (being) good*, **bigabiga** *be muddy* [1 for idea, 2 for semantic diff. OR list]
- All verbs have a reduplicated form. [0.5]
 - The reduplicated form is often not predictable (as can be seen in the table at the foot of the explanation). [0.5]
 - Two verbs, **bigabiga** and **dewadewa** are reduplicated in their basic form (where other verbs are unreduplicated) and they do not reduplicate further (where other verbs do). [1]
- Verbs mark their subject with a prefix and their object with a suffix [1], as follows:

2sg	u-	-m
3sg	i-	-ya
2pl	o-	-mi
3pl	hi-	-hi [1 if all correct]

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- The reduplicated form of an *active* verb may be used to indicate the durative aspect. [1]
- When a verb follows either **apo** or **inapa**, the verb takes **-na-** after the prefix. [1]
[This marks the potential mood.]

Adjectives. 4 marks

- Adjectives are derived from the reduplicated form of verbs. [1]
- Adjectives derived from stative verbs have a more permanent meaning than the root verb (e.g. *be muddy* > *swampy*, *be dying* > *dead*, *be staying* > *settled*). [1]
- They take a possessive suffix to agree with the noun they are modifying. [1]
- They can act as a predicate (where they still take a suffix to agree with the noun) but they cannot take **-na-**, so cannot co-occur with either **apo** or **inapa**. [1]

Syntax 5 marks

- The basic word order is SOV, but subject and object can be omitted if marked on the verb. [1]
- Two clauses can be linked by **ma** *and/but* or **babana** *because*, both standing after the first clause, or by **inapa** *if* standing before it. [0.5]
- Adjectives come directly after the noun they are modifying. [0.5]
- Possessed nouns are preceded by their possessors. [0.5]
- A noun N can be directly followed by a possessed noun N_P in predicate position to mean “N has N_P”. [0.5]
- **Ega** *not* precedes any part of the clause it is negating. [1]
- **Apo** *will* comes at the start of the clause. [0.5]
- **Nu** *to* precedes the noun. [0.5]

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single, prefixed			double, prefixed			double, suffixed		
#	form	meaning	#	form	meaning	#	form	meaning
2	o+ na +nae	you ... go	8	u+ na + <u>nen</u> ae	you are going			
1	u+hilage	you are dying				11	<u>hi</u> hilage+hi	are dead
9	u+ na +gobu	you ... be dirty				5	<u>gobu</u> gobu+hi	are stained
15	hi+gobu	they are dirty						
9	u+ na +peu	you fall				10	<u>pi</u> peu+na	falling
16	hi+peu	they fall						
10	i+mae	is staying				3	<u>me</u> me+hi	are settled
						12	<u>me</u> me+na	settled
14	i+ na +dao	it ... be long				11	<u>da</u> odao+hi	long
			13	i+ <u>to</u> wotowolo	he is standing	16	<u>to</u> wotowolo+hi	standing
			1	o+ na + <u>dewa</u> dewa a	you ... be good	7	<u>dewa</u> dewa+na	good
			2	o+ <u>da</u> ladala	you are crawling	15	<u>da</u> ladala+na	crawling
			14	i+ <u>bi</u> gabiga	is muddy	5	<u>bi</u> gabiga+na	swampy
13 ,1 5	o+gale+ya i+gale+mi	you see him he sees you (pl)						
8	hi+ na +pani+m	they imprison you (sg)						
			6	hi+ <u>du</u> huhuna	they are sitting down			
			7	i+ <u>da</u> nedanene+ hi	is stealing them			